

PROGRAMME BROCHURE

China Quest

知行中国

Structured International Learning Programme

A structured educational journey through China's culture, technology, and future, designed to deliver real-world learning and meaningful student outcomes.

Ages 14–18

Transition Year Compatible

Modular City Design

From €2,990

Designed for Transition Year, summer programmes,
and school-designed international modules

A Structured Learning Journey, Not Just a Study Trip

China Quest helps students explore China through culture, technology, and real-world experience, with reflection, discussion, and meaningful outcomes built in.

Evidence-Based Learning

Students investigate real places and social dynamics through guided observation, discussion, and reflection.

Their insights can be documented through journals and portfolio-style outputs that support TY learning.

Critical Thinking

Independent Research

Reflection

Authentic Cultural Immersion

Students encounter China not only through landmarks, but through neighbourhoods, daily life, and meaningful human interaction.

The aim is to develop cultural understanding, empathy, and learning beyond the tourist gaze.

Cultural Intelligence

Interpersonal Skills

Global Awareness

Next-Gen Innovation

Students explore the technologies shaping modern China through first-hand exposure to robotics, AI, mobility, and innovation ecosystems.

These experiences connect academic interests with future pathways and real-world change.

STEM Readiness

Career Exploration

Sustainable Thinking

"纸上得来终觉浅，绝知此事要躬行。"

What is learned from books remains shallow. True understanding comes only through experience.

— Lu You, Song Dynasty poet (1125–1210)

HOW IT WORKS

How the Learning Journey Works

Each day combines exploration, reflection, challenge, and discussion. Students do more than visit places — they learn through them.

Daily Learning Cycle — Repeated daily, deepened over time

1

Exploration

Real places and expert-led observation

2

Reflection

Journaling and discussion

3

Challenge

Inquiry, documentation, creative response

4

Circle

Shared debrief and exchange

Learning Pillars

Technology & Innovation

AI, robotics, mobility, digital change

Arts & Culture

Craft, calligraphy, performance, creativity

History & Heritage

Landmarks, museums, memory, identity

Social & Urban Life

Neighbourhoods, transit, markets, youth culture

Designed with TY and school-led learning in mind. Structured tasks can support reflection journals, creative outputs, and portfolio-style evidence. Schools are welcome to nominate a teacher to accompany the group, strengthening continuity, shared reflection, and alignment with school values.

Four Core Modules Across Modern China

Each city module offers a distinct lens on China · typically 5 days · combinable into longer programmes

Beijing

Roots, Identity, and Living Heritage

Great Wall, imperial landmarks, and the continuity of Chinese civilisation. Hutong observation, calligraphy, and everyday cultural practice.

A module focused on how history, memory, and identity shape modern China

Shanghai

Global Interface, Exchange, and Modern Chinese Identity

The Bund, Pudong, and the story of urban transformation. School exchange, peer dialogue, and neighbourhood discovery.

A module focused on global connection, cultural fusion, and city life in contemporary China

Shenzhen

Future Ecosystems, Innovation, and STEM Exploration

Technology ecosystems, robotics, and hands-on innovation exposure. Smart mobility, urban change, and future city systems.

A module focused on how design, making, and innovation shape the world students are growing into

Hong Kong

Crossroads, Sustainability, and Global Outlook

Harbour, density, and East–West urban histories. Field-based sustainability learning and local community observation.

A module focused on comparison, reflection, and bringing the wider journey into sharper perspective

Additional city modules (Hangzhou, Chengdu, Xi'an) available on request.

"读万卷书，不如行万里路。"

Reading ten thousand books is not as good as travelling ten thousand miles.

— Dong Qichang, Ming Dynasty scholar (1555–1636)

What Students Gain

Students return with more than memories — they gain confidence, perspective, and evidence of meaningful learning.

Tangible Learning Evidence

Students return with documented observations, reflective journals, creative outputs, and a certificate of completion that can support TY portfolio work.

Depending on the module, students may also produce interview notes, short research tasks, visual documentation, or digital storytelling work.

Global Fluency & Core Competencies

Through teamwork, reflection, and cross-cultural engagement, students strengthen adaptability, communication, collaboration, and critical thinking.

The programme helps students move beyond passive observation and develop confidence to interpret, question, and respond to unfamiliar environments.

Career & Future Pathways

Exposure to innovation, urban change, and professional environments helps students connect academic interests with future possibilities.

From technology ecosystems to cultural institutions and university settings, students gain first-hand insight into worlds they may one day study in, work in, or help shape.

Reflection Journals · Creative Outputs · TY Portfolio Evidence · Certificate of Completion

SAFETY & SCHOOL SUPPORT

Supporting Student Wellbeing at Every Stage

China Quest is designed to support student wellbeing, clear supervision, and practical collaboration with schools throughout the journey.

Clear Supervision

Students are supported by experienced bilingual leaders, with clear group supervision and structured daily coordination throughout the programme.

Risk-Aware Planning

Programmes are delivered with risk awareness built in, including route planning, activity review, emergency response procedures, and clear communication protocols.

School-Facing Support

Schools are welcome to nominate a teacher to accompany the group, helping strengthen continuity, pastoral support, and alignment with school expectations.

Student Wellbeing

Accommodation, transport, meals, and day-to-day logistics are planned to support student comfort and safety. Insurance cover, medical access, and clear communication procedures are built in.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What ages is China Quest suitable for?

China Quest is designed for students aged 14–18. Programme content, supervision, and activities are tailored to this age group, with a balance of challenge, support, and structured learning.

What is a city module?

A city module is a structured part of the programme built around a specific learning lens, such as history, globalisation, innovation, or sustainability. Each module has its own theme, duration, and set of core experiences, and modules can be combined to create a broader journey.

How long are the programmes?

Programmes are built from city-based learning modules. Core city modules are typically 5 days and can be combined into longer programmes depending on your school's goals, student group, and schedule.

Can schools customise the itinerary?

Yes. Schools can select and combine modules, adjust the overall programme length, and discuss specific themes or priorities. We work with each school to shape a programme that fits its students, goals, and schedule.

Can a teacher accompany the group?

Yes. Schools are welcome to nominate a teacher to accompany the group. A travelling teacher can help support continuity, pastoral care, reflection, and alignment with school expectations throughout the programme.

Who runs China Quest?

China Quest is run by Miles Minds Limited, an Ireland-based education company with a team across China. It is delivered with local support, bilingual leadership, and a strong focus on school-facing programme design.

Do students need to speak Chinese?

No. All programme leaders are bilingual, and activities are delivered in English. Students may naturally pick up a few basic phrases along the way, but no prior Chinese language knowledge is required.

Is China safe for student groups?

Yes. China Quest is designed with student wellbeing, clear supervision, and risk-aware planning in mind. Programmes include experienced bilingual leaders, a maximum 1:8 leader-to-student ratio, defined emergency procedures, and international travel and health insurance.

What happens in an emergency?

Each programme includes clearly defined emergency procedures, including immediate medical access, direct communication channels, and practical travel adjustments where needed. Detailed emergency and supervision information is available in the School Pack.

What is included in the programme fee?

Programme fees typically include accommodation, meals, domestic transport, entry fees, core activities, insurance, learning materials, and 24/7 bilingual support. International flights, visa fees, and personal spending are not included. Full details are available in the School Pack.

Is the programme Transition Year compatible?

Yes. China Quest is designed with Transition Year learning in mind, including reflection tasks, portfolio-style outputs, and opportunities for collaboration, autonomy, and critical thinking.

Can China Quest support Gaisce?

Some elements of the programme may support TY portfolio work and may also align with aspects of Gaisce, depending on each student's goals and school or PAL guidance. We recommend discussing this with your school in advance.

How do we get started?

Simply get in touch via email at info@milesminds.com or call +353 87 775 8146. We can share the School Pack, answer questions, and arrange an introductory call or presentation.

Ready to Explore?

Get in touch to receive the full School Information Pack

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